

Course Evaluation Response Rate Analysis

Fall 2021 – Spring 2025 · Habib University

Objective: To develop a clearer understanding of response rate trends across semesters and identify key gaps or pain points in participation.

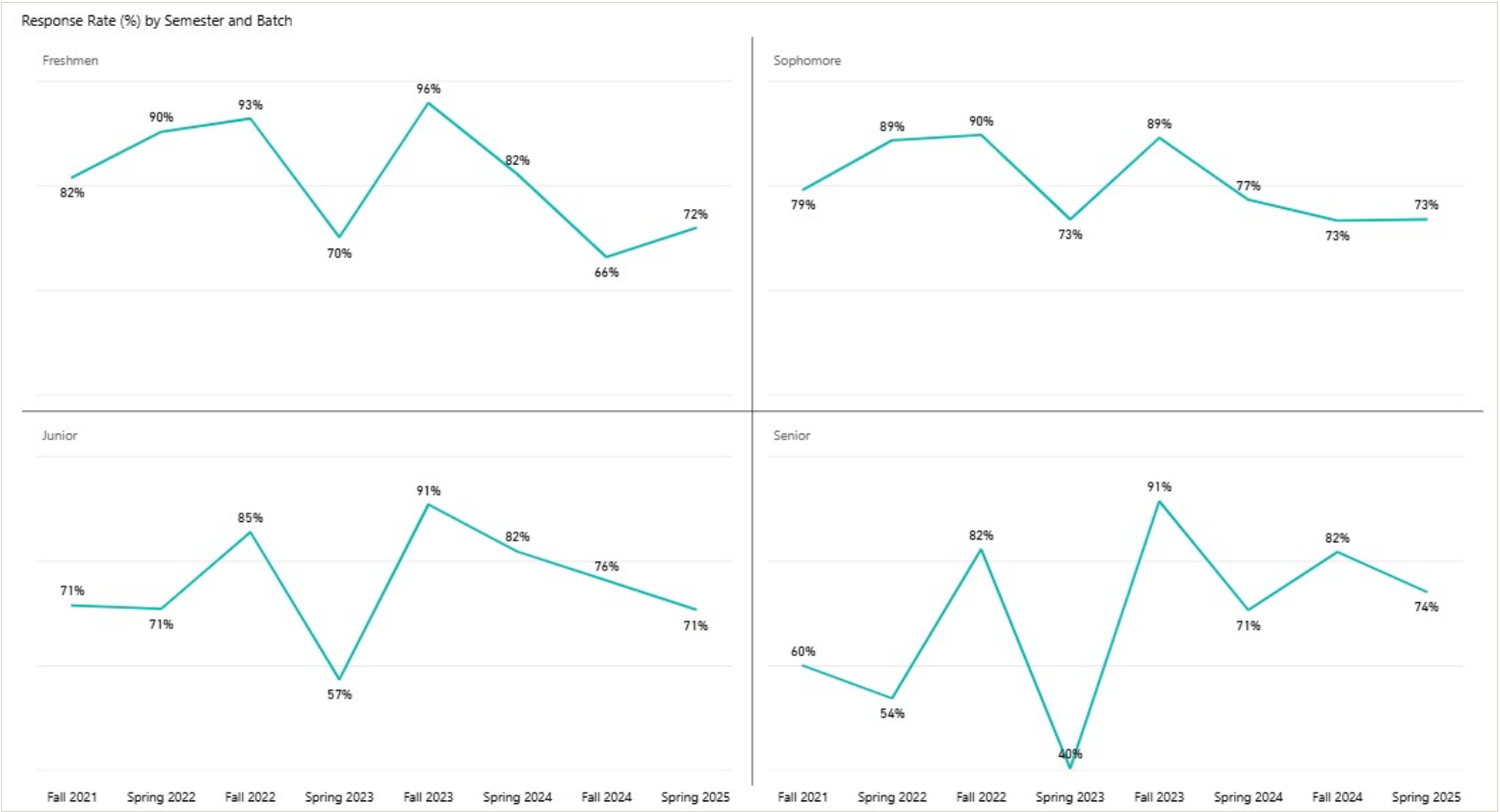
- Semester-wise trends
- Batch-wise comparisons
- Course categories
- Faculty designations
- Course levels (100–400)
- Program-level insights

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Overall response rate trends

Response rates generally stayed above 70%, with Spring 2023 as a notable exception when reminders and incentives were not enforced. The sharp rebound in Fall 2023 demonstrates the effectiveness of structured interventions such as weekly reminders and a revised evaluation process. Yet the subsequent decline across most cohorts — even when class time was allotted — suggests either diminishing returns from these measures or a general disengagement that seems to be cohort specific.

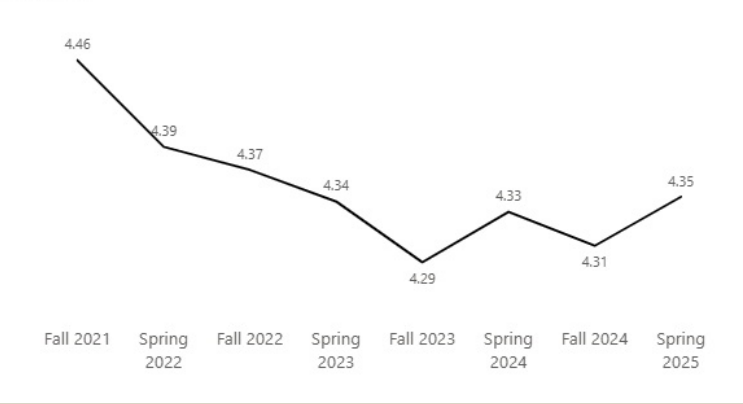
For seniors, response rates follow a clear semester pattern — rising in Fall and dropping in Spring, likely reflecting end-of-program pressures as graduation approaches. The relative stability among seniors and sophomores (whose overall rates improved gradually over time) suggests the issue is not uniform across the student body; program- or cohort-specific factors are likely at play.



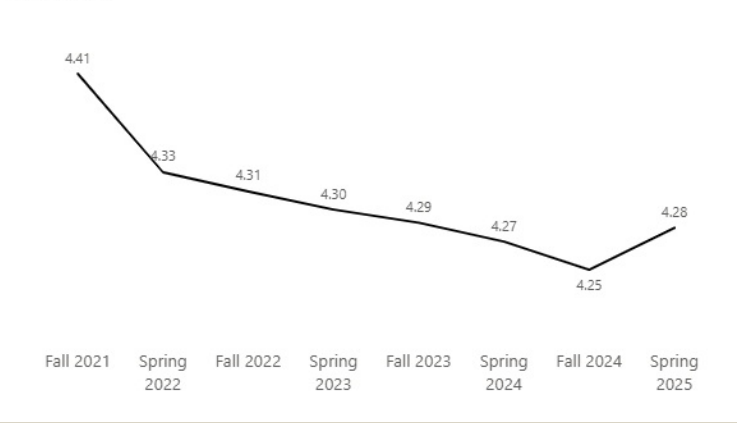
Course content, pedagogy & assessment ratings over time

Across all semesters, response rates decline after Fall 2023, suggesting possible cohort-specific dissatisfaction rather than simple fatigue. Even when batch sizes remain comparable, response rates fluctuate sharply — pointing to declining willingness to respond, which tracks a parallel decline in how students rate pedagogy, assessment, and content.

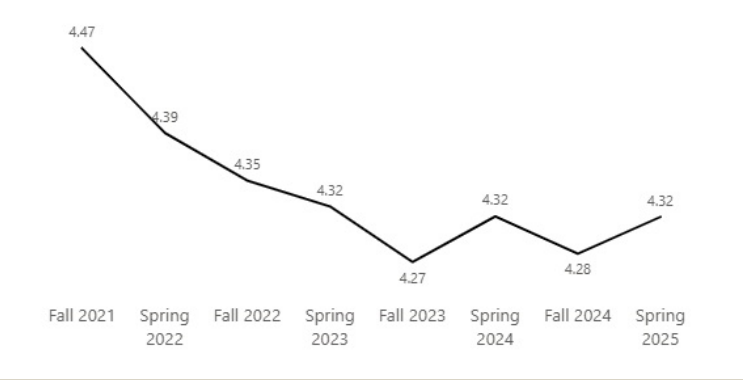
Pedagogy



Assessment



Content



Changes in response by student year and school

In **AHSS**, there has been a pronounced response rate decline amongst freshmen and juniors, marking a shift from earlier patterns when seniors were least responsive. Seniors still have somewhat lower absolute numbers, but their response rate has been improving over time.

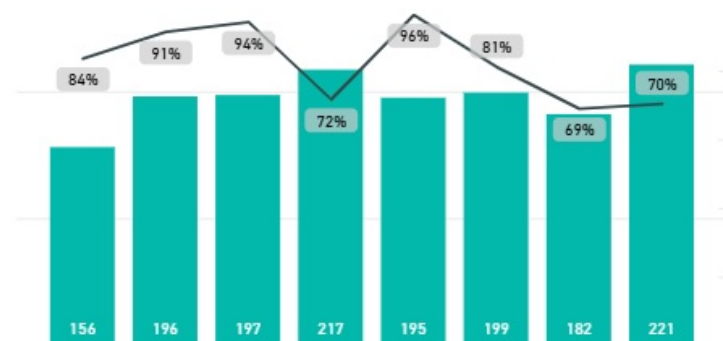


In **DSSE**, freshmen, juniors, and seniors record the lowest overall participation rates. Freshmen maintained historically high engagement until Fall 2023, after which their response rates declined sharply — a drop that cannot be explained by batch size alone, since similar cohort sizes in earlier years produced higher response rates.

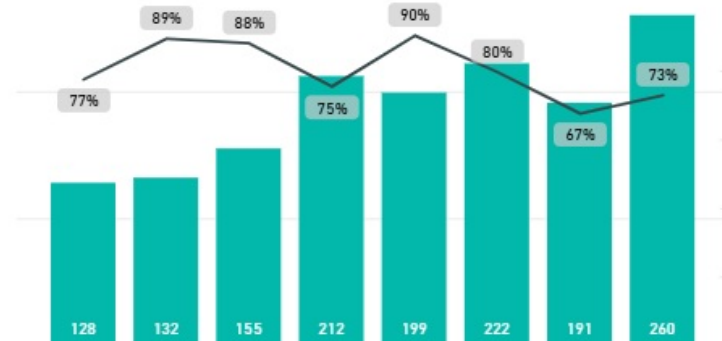
DSSE-Batch Size and Response Rate (%) by Semester and Batch

● Batch Size ● Response Rate (%)

Freshmen



Sophomore



Junior



Senior



After controlling for semester, program, and course level, the regression analysis suggests that **freshmen are the most responsive group** overall — but **juniors are about 26% less likely** to respond than freshmen, and **seniors are nearly 50% less likely**, controlling for all other effects.

Course-level variations

A clear trend shift is visible post-Fall 2023 across all programs. Compared to an arbitrary program (e.g. Comparative Humanities), students in **ECE were about 27% less likely** to respond, and **SDP students 10% less likely**. In SDP specifically, response rates for 100- and 400-level courses have consistently declined post-Fall 2023 — though this pattern does not generalize to AHSS as a whole, where CH shows higher response rates in higher-level courses.

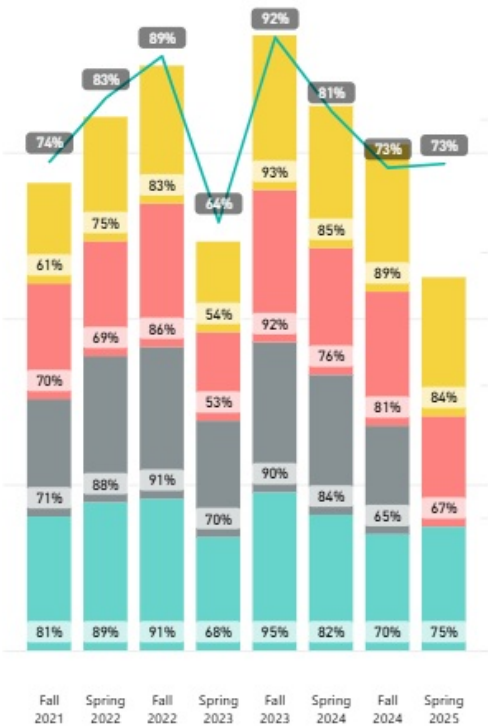


A similar post-Fall 2023 decline appears in ECE (DSSE), where the weakest responses occur in 100- and 300-level courses. CS (DSSE) instead maintains stronger engagement at the 300- and 400-levels. Overall, students in 400-level courses are **9% more likely** to participate than those in 100-level courses — advanced, more specialized courses appear to foster greater investment in feedback.

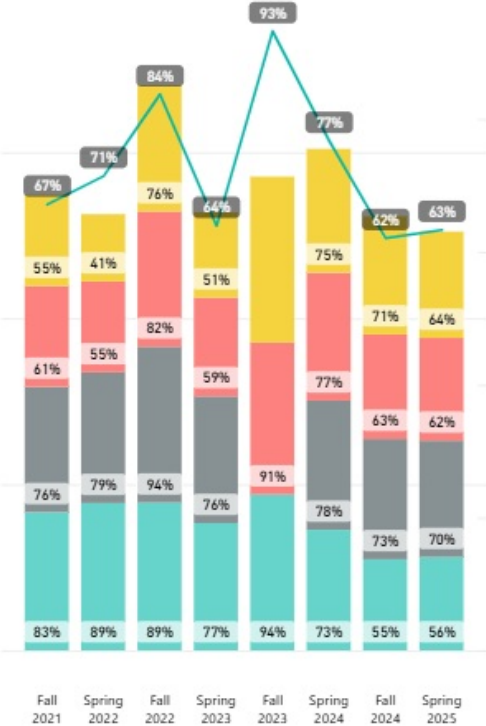
Response Rate (%) by Semester and Course Level (DSSE)

Course Level 100 200 300 400 Response Rate (%)

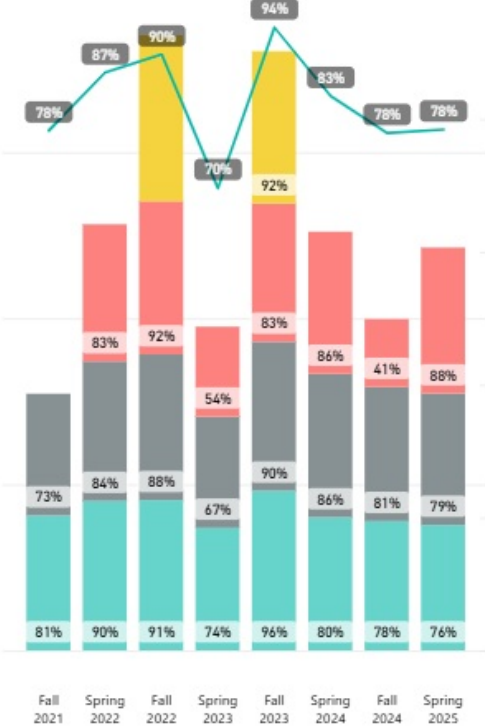
CS



ECE

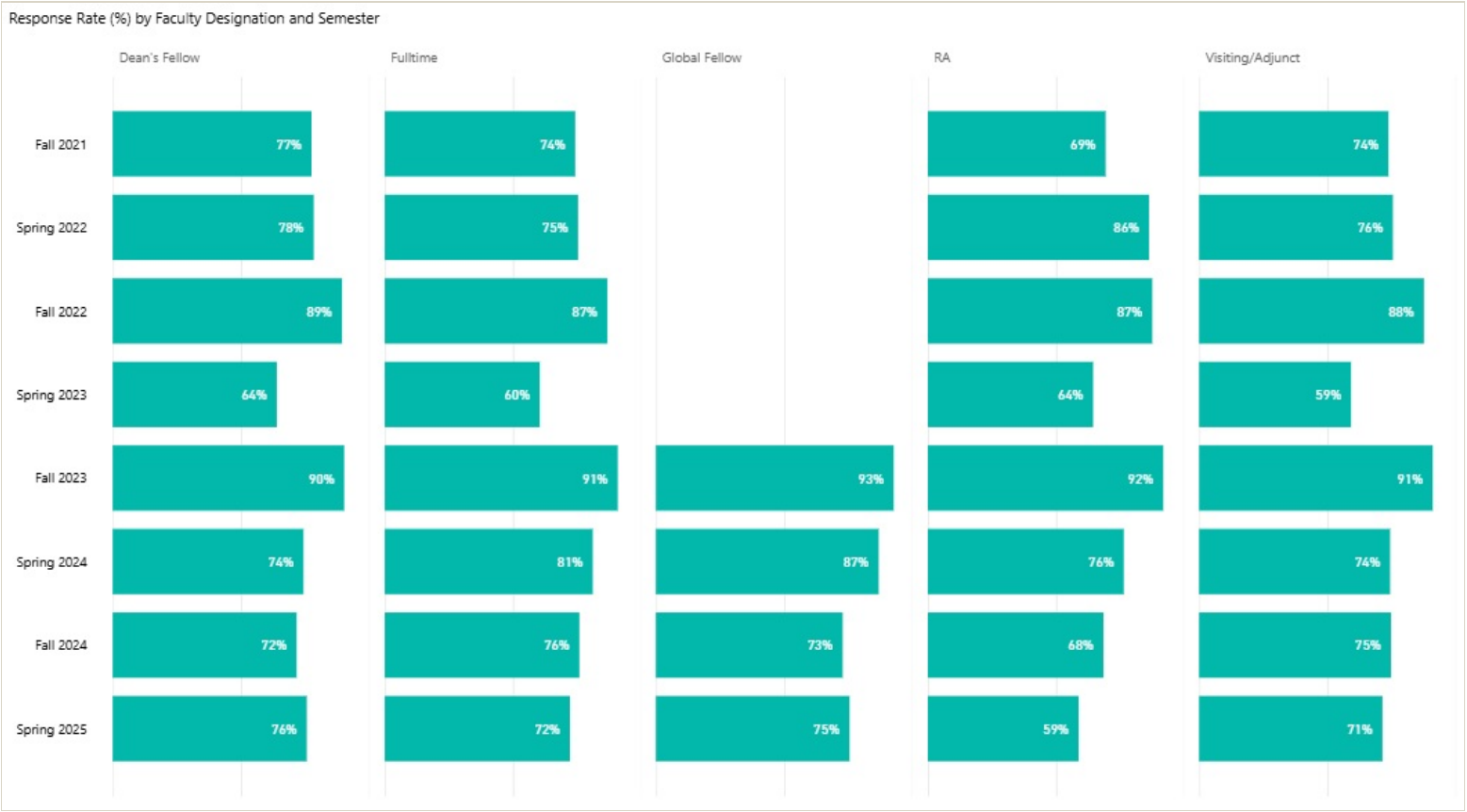


ISCIM



Faculty designation effects

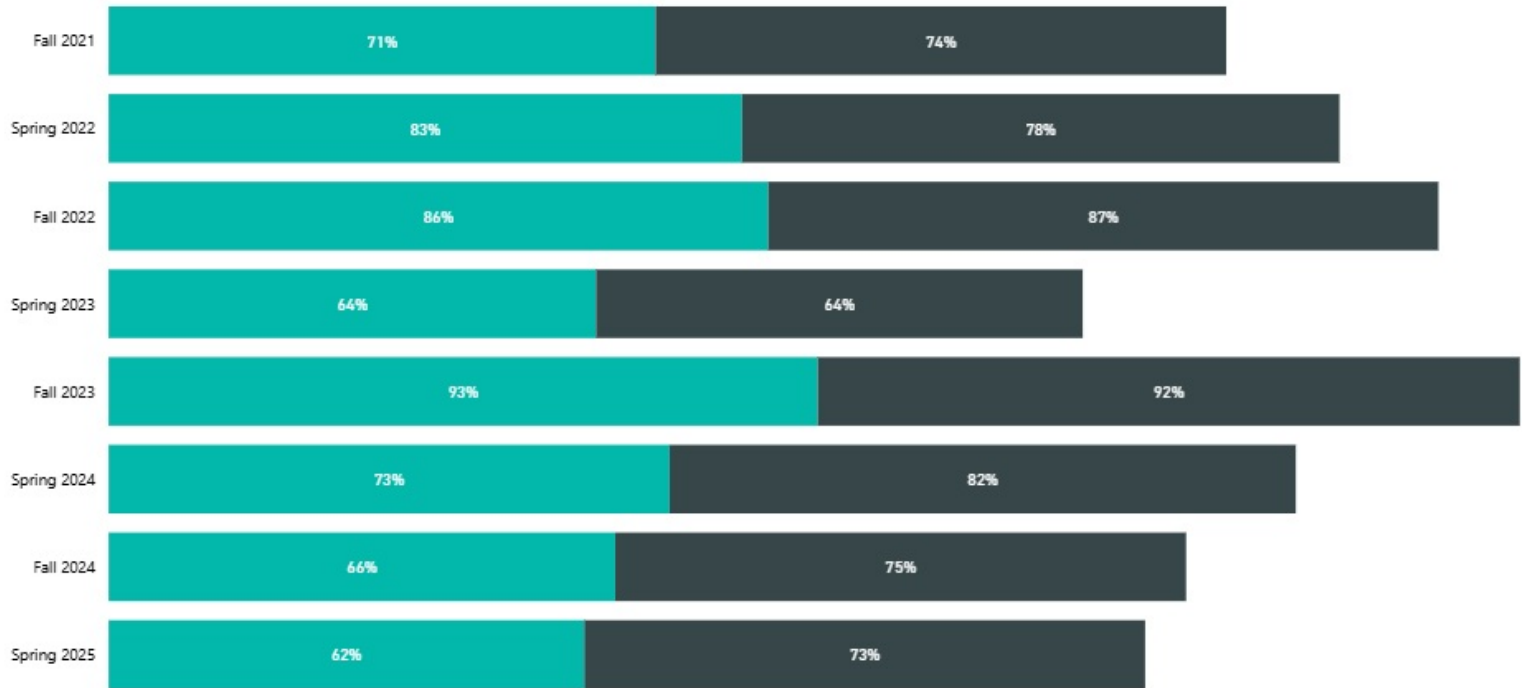
Response rates across designations generally remain strong (above 70%), suggesting designation alone may not drive engagement. Still, controlling for other factors, **full-time faculty secure up to 21% higher participation** than Visiting/Adjunct faculty — plausibly because permanent faculty have had more time to acclimatize to student and university culture and more actively encourage responses.



The decline is steepest for **Research Assistants**, whose teaching is often tied to labs or support courses that students may view as less formal. This aligns with the broader trend of lower response rates for **Labs** compared to **Lectures**.

Response Rate (%) by Semester and Course Component

Course_Component LAB LEC



Summary: target groups with lowest response rates

School	Batch	Program	Course level	Faculty designation	Course component
AHSS	Freshmen & Juniors	SDP	100 & 400	Visiting/Adjunct	—
DSSE	Freshmen, Juniors & Seniors	ECE	100 & 300	Visiting/Adjunct & RAs	Labs

Taken together, the evidence suggests declining participation stems from both general disengagement in newer cohorts — reflected in declining ratings on content, pedagogy, and assessment — and program-, cohort-, and designation-specific dynamics. Addressing this will require targeted interventions that go beyond procedural adjustments, focusing instead on strengthening structural and pedagogical alignment.